

Proposed Team Structure for a Systematic Literature Review

Tier 1: Strategic Leadership & Coordination (2 Roles)

1. Lead Author / Principal Investigator (PI): Ultimately responsible for the research question, intellectual direction, and academic rigor. Makes final decisions on inclusion/exclusion criteria, quality assessment frameworks, and synthesis methodology. Writes key sections (Abstract, Introduction, Discussion, Conclusion) and is the corresponding author.
2. Project Manager / Methodology Lead: Manages the PRISMA process. Creates and maintains the project plan, deadlines (for search, screening, extraction), and runs team meetings. Ensures the SLR protocol is registered (e.g., on PROSPERO, if applicable) and strictly adhered to. The "guardian of the methodology."

Tier 2: The Core Execution Engine (7 Roles)

This is where the heavy lifting happens. Think of these as pairs or small groups working in parallel streams.

Phase 1: Search & Screening

3. Search Strategist / Librarian: Develops the complex Boolean search strings for digital libraries (IEEE Xplore, ACM DL, Scopus, Web of Science, etc.). Documents the exact search strategy for reproducibility. Manages reference management software (Zotero, Mendeley, EndNote) for the entire team.
4. & 5. Primary Screeners (Two researchers): Independently screen all retrieved article titles and abstracts against the inclusion/exclusion criteria. Use a tool like Rayyan.ai to manage blinded screening and resolve conflicts. Their inter-rater reliability is a key quality metric.

Phase 2: Deep Analysis & Data Extraction

6. & 7. Full-Text Analysts / Data Extractors (Two researchers): Obtain and deeply read the papers that pass the initial screening. They pilot-test and then use a standardized data extraction form (created by the team) to pull out: authors, year, methodology, key findings, strengths, limitations, etc. They also conduct quality assessments (e.g., using CASP or JBI checklists).
8. Data Synthesis & Visualization Specialist: Takes the extracted data and synthesizes it. Creates meaningful tables, thematic matrices, and conceptual frameworks. Develops high-quality visualizations, including PRISMA flow diagrams, bubble charts, heat maps, and thematic maps. Master's tools like VOSviewer, CitNetExplorer, or even advanced Excel/Python/R.

Phase 3: Writing & Assembly

9. Synthesis Writer / Results Section Lead: Writes the core Results/Findings section. Transforms the synthesized data and visualizations into a compelling narrative. This person must be excellent at describing patterns, contrasts, and gaps in the literature without inserting their own opinion.
10. Chief Editor & Formatting Czar: (Your key compiler). Maintains the master document (LaTeX/Overleaf or Word). Enforces a consistent style (e.g., APA, IEEE). Manages citations and the reference list. Collates drafts from all writers, ensures logical flow, and prepares the final manuscript for submission according to the target journal's guidelines.